MIL-N-37288A
14 May 1976
SUPERSEDING
MIL-N-37288
31 July 1975

MILITARY SPECIFICATION

NEOMYCIN SULFATE, GRAMICIDIN, AND POLYMYXIN B SULFATE CREAM

This specification is approved for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This specification covers Neomycin Sulfate, Gramicidin, and Polymyxin B Sulfate Cream (See 6.2).

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 Issues of documents. The following documents, of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposals, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein.

SPECIFICATIONS

Federal

PPP-C-186	Containers, Packaging and Packing for Drugs, Chemicals, and Pharmaceuticals (See 6.3)

Military

MIL-STD-105	Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129	Marking for Shipment and Storage.

(Copies of specifications and standards required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T10:22Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise indicated, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposals shall apply.

U. S. DEPARTMENT OF HEALTH, EDUCATION, AND WELFARE, FOOD AND DRUG ADMINISTRATION

Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and Regulations Promulgated Thereunder.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Food and Drug Administration, Washington, DC 20204.)

U. S. PHARMACOPEIAL CONVENTION, INC.

The United States Pharmacopeia.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Mack Publishing Company, Easton, PA 18042.)

National Formulary.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Mack Publishing Company, Easton, PA 18042.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Material. Shall be a smooth, white, homogeneous, opaque, water-washable, vanishing cream, free from gritty particles and foreign matter. In addition, each gram of cream shall be in accordance with the following formula:

Polymyxin B Sulfate - - - - - - - - - -	10,000 units
Neomycin (as Neomycin Sulfate)- - - -	3.5 mg
Gramicidin - - - - - - - - - - - - - - -	250 mcg

The active ingredients shall be in a base composed of: Mineral Oil, White Petrolatum, Purified Water, Propylene Glycol, Polyoxyethylene Polyoxypropylene Compound, Emulsifying Wax, and 0.25% Methylparaben as a preservative.

3.2 Each lot of each antibiotic used in the manufacture of the cream shall be certified by the Food and Drug Administration (F.D.A.).

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 20261O-21T10:22Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

3.3 Certification. The finished cream shall conform to the pertinent provisions of the General Regulations for the Certification of Antibiotics and Antibiotic-Containing Drugs, as promulgated by the F.D.A., U. S. Department of Health, Education, and Welfare.

3.4 Active ingredients:

3.4.1 Polymyxin B Sulfate and Neomycin Sulfate. The Polymyxin B Sulfate and the Neomycin Sulfate, entering into the preparation of the cream, shall be in accordance with the tests, standards, and requirements of the U.S.P., including any supplements or revisions thereto.

3.4.2 Gramicidin. The Gramicidin used in the preparation of the cream shall be in accordance with the tests, standards, and requirements of the N.F., including any supplements or revisions thereto.

3.4.3 Other ingredients.

3.4.3.1 Mineral Oil, White Petrolatum, Purified Water, Propylene Glycol, and Methylparaben. The Mineral Oil, White Petrolatum, Purified Water, Propylene Glycol, and Methylparaben, used in the preparation of the cream shall be in accordance with the tests, standards, and requirements of the U.S.P., including any supplements or revisions thereto.

3.4.3.2 All other ingredients used in the preparation of the cream shall be of a suitable grade for use in manufacture of the cream. The testing shall be acceptable to the F.D.A.

3.5 Assay. The cream shall assay to contain not less than 90.0 percent and not more than 130.0 percent of the required amount of each of the Polymyxin B Sulfate, Neomycin, and the Gramicidin.

3.6 Expiration Dating Period. The expiration dating period shall be 36 months.

3.7 Delivery. Not less than 33 months of the expiration dating period shall remain at the time of delivery of the cream to the Government.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T10:22Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Supplier responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or order, the supplier may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.1.1 Records of examinations and tests performed by or for the contractor shall be maintained by the contractor and made available to the Government, upon the Government's request, at any time, or from time to time, during the performance of the contract and, (i) as to any expiration dated item, for the expiration dating period (potency period) specified by the contractor for such item, or such longer period as may be required by regulation of any federal agency; or (ii) as to non-dated items, for not less than 3 years after delivery of the items to the Government.

4.1.2 No company supplying any ingredient(s) to the contractor will be considered an acceptable facility for the performance of any inspection requirements specified herein.

4.1.2 Lot. For purposes of this specification, a lot batch, or control is that single, uniform, and homogeneous quantity of cream produced from one formulation, subjected to the same compounding and manufacturing operation, and filled into final containers.

4.2 Sampling. Sampling shall be conducted in accordance with Military Standard MIL-STD-105.

TABLE I. Sampling

For visual examination	Inspection level	AQL (percent defective)	Unit of product
Major	S-2	1.0	Filled tube
Minor	II	2.5	Unit package

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T10:22Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

4.2.1 For raw material and end item testing. Noncompliance with any of the following shall be cause for rejection.

TABLE II. For raw material and end item testing

Characteristic	Requirement paragraph	Inspection level 1/	Minimum sample
End item:			
Assay	3.5	S-2 Composite of final, filled tubes	5
Contents	PPP-C-186	S-2	10
Leakage	---	PPP-C-186	10
Active ingredients:		2/	
Polymyxin B Sulfate	3.4.1		
Neomycin Sulfate	3.4.1		
Gramicidin	3.4.2		
Other ingredients:	3.4.3.1 and 3.4.3.2		

1/Where possible, the same sample shall be used for two (2) or more tests.

2/Sufficient quantities shall be selected from each lot of raw material to perform tests indicated in applicable test methods. Failure of any sample to comply with test requirements shall be cause for rejection of the lot represented.

4.3 Examination. The Neomycin Sulfate, Gramicidin, and Polymyxin B Sulfate Cream shall be examined to determine compliance with all requirements of this specification. Nonconformance will be permitted to the extent indicated in 4.2 and 4.2.1.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T10:22Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

4.3.1 Classification of defects. Examination will be conducted in accordance with the following classification of defects:

TABLE III. Classification of defects

Categories	Defects 1/
Major	
101	Cream not smooth.
102	Cream not white.
103	Cream not homogeneous, not free from separation.
104	Cream not opaque.
105	Cream not water-washable, vanishing cream type.
106	Cream not free from gritty particles.
107	Cream not free fron foreign matter.
108	Cream not free from lumps or other unincorporated material.
109	Cream not compatible with container.
110	Labeling not legible, not free from defacing marks and tears.
Minor	
201	Exterior of tube not free from contents or foreign matter.
202	Unit package, if supplied, not free from stains.
203	Tube not free from pitting, cracking, flaking, or peeling.

Labeling, Marking, Packaging, and Packing shall be as specified. Acceptance number shall be zero (0).

1/ Inspection is not restricted to the classified possible defects listed above.

4.4 Tests.

4.4.1 Tests and examinations. Tests and examinations shall be performed to determine compliance with all requirements of this document and all referenced documents.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T10:22Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

4.5 Packaging inspection. The inspection of the intermediate package, packing and marking for shipment and storage shall be in accordance with quality assurance provisions of the applicable container specification and the marking requirements of MIL-STD-129.

4.6 Labeling inspection. Sampling shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105 and the unit of product shall be the unit of issue. The inspection lot shall be the number of units of issue of each batch, lot, control number, etc., offered for inspection at one time. The inspection level for labeling shall be S-2 and the acceptable number shall be zero.

5. PACKAGING

5.1 Packaging requirements. The requirements for packaging shall be in accordance with applicable requirements of PPP-C-186 (see 6.3) and as specified herein.

5.2 Packaging. Packaging shall be level A or C as specified (see 6.1).

5.2.1 Unit of issue. One tube containing 15 grams of topical cream, as specified, constitutes one unit of issue.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T10:22Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

5.2.2 Level A.

5.2.2.1 Immediate container. The immediate container shall be a commercially available tube considered acceptable by the Food and Drug Administration (FDA) for the product contained therein and shall be of such compatibility that neither the contents nor the container are altered in any way by each other.

5.2.2.2 Unit package. At the option of the contractor, a unit package may be furnished. If a unit package is furnished, each tube shall be packaged as specified in paragraph 5.2.5 of PPP-C-186.

5.2.2.3 Intermediate package. Twelve units of issue shall be packaged as specified in 5.2.12.1 of PPP-C-186. When unit packages are furnished, the intermediate package may be a plastic film shrink wrap.

5.2.3 Level C. Units shall be packaged in standard commercial containers of the size and kind commonly used, which will afford the degree of protection required for shipment and use of the product for its intended purpose.

5.3 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B or C as specified (see 6.1).

5.3.1 Level A. Thirty-six intermediate packages (432 units) shall be packed in an exterior container as specified in 5.4.4 of PPP-C-186.

5.3.2 Level B. Thirty-six intermediate packages (432 units) shall be packed in an exterior container as specified in 5.4.3.5.1 of PPP-C-186.

5.3.3 Level C. The subject commodity shall be packed in substantial commercial containers of the type, size, and kind commonly used for the purpose, so constructed as to insure acceptance and safe delivery by common or other carriers, at the lowest rate, to point of delivery called for in the contract or purchase order.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T10:22Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

5.4 Marking.

5.4.1 Labeling. Labeling shall be in accordance with the requirements of the Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act and shall include the information required below:

5.4.1.1 Immediate container. Each immediate container label shall bear the following information:

(a) label information in accordance with commercial practice.

(b) the expiration date.

5.4.1.2 Unit packages. Each unit package label shall bear the following information:

(a) label information in accordance with commercial practice.
(b) the National Stock Number.
(c) extended potency lines.

NOTES: (1) The National Stock Number shall not be preceded by any prefix.
(2) Strip labeling may be used.
(3) Label adhesion test shall not apply.
(4) If a unit package is not supplied, the National Stock Number and extended potency lines shall appear on the immediate container label.

5.4.2 Intermediate package. Each intermediate package shall be marked in accordance with 5.5.3 of PPP-C-186. Type II Shelf Life marking as specified in MIL-STD-129 shall be shown. Marking shall include the legend: "STORE AT CONTROLLED ROOM TEMPERATURE 15° - 30° C (59° - 86° F)".

5.4.3 Exterior container. Exterior container shall be marked in accordance with 5.5.4 of PPP-C-186. Type II Shelf Life marking as specified in MIL-STD-129 shall be shown. Marking shall include the legend: "STORE AT CONTROLLED ROOM TEMPERATURE 15° - 30° C (59° - 86° F)".

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T10:22Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

6. NOTES

6.1 Ordering data. Procurement documents should specify the following:

(a) Title, number and date of this specification.
(b) the National Stock Number.
(c) Selection of applicable levels of packaging and packing (See 5.2 and 5.3).

6.2 This specification covers the following item(s):,

National Stock Number	Item Identification
6505-00-926-2159	NEOMYCIN SULFATE, GRAMICIDIN, AND POLYMYXIN B SULFATE CREAM, Topical, 15 Grams

6.3 All references to PPP-C-186 refer to Interim Federal Specification PPP-C-00186B which is mandatory for use until superseded by a revision.

Custodians:
Army - MD
Navy - MS
Air Force - 03

Preparing activity:
Defense Supply Agency - DM

Project No. 6505-1564

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T10:22Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.